

Mila Matich

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Summary

Environmental Studies student with research experience in marine ecology, biological surveys, and ecological data analysis. Skilled in species identification, laboratory work and data analysis. Driven and detail-oriented with excellent observational, organizational and communication skills.

Education

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SANTA BARBARA

Environmental Studies (Bachelor's in Science)

GPA: 3.98

Awards: Dean's honors (L.S.), Published author in the 2026 Edition of *Starting Lines*, Recipient of the Paul Walker Scholarship in Environmental Planning

Relevant Coursework: *Introduction to Biology, Ecology, Chemistry, Physics and Statistics, Marine Biology, Environmental Coding*

Santa Barbara, CA

Expected: June 2027

UNIVERSITY OF QUEENSLAND, ST. LUCIA CAMPUS

UCEAP Marine Biology and Terrestrial Ecology Study Abroad Program

Brisbane, Australia

August 2025 – November 2025

MIRA COSTA HIGH SCHOOL

GPA: 4.0 (unweighted), 4.39 (weighted)

Awards: *California Scholarship Federation (all semesters), Scholar Athlete & Principal's Honor Roll (all semesters), AP Scholar Award (2023), Achievement in Mathematics (AP Calculus) (2023), Achievement in Spanish (AP Spanish) (2023), Link Crew Service Award (2023), Mira Costa High School Outstanding Scholastic Achievement Scholar Award in AP Spanish (2022), All Awards Nominations: National Honor Society (2022), Charlaire Deatherage Award (2022), Mira Costa High School Outstanding Scholastic Achievement Scholar Award in Math (2019), Student of the Month (2019) Girl Scouts of USA Silver Award (2019), Girl Scouts of USA Bronze Award (2016)*

Manhattan Beach, CA

Graduated June 2023

Research Experience

MARINE BIOLOGY & TERRESTRIAL ECOLOGY UCEAP

Giant Clam Ecology Research Project

Brisbane, Australia

August 2025 - November 2025

- Conducted field surveys assessing giant clam (*Tridacna maxima*) ecology and responses to anthropogenic stress
- Collected data by taking in-situ measurements of organism size, orientation, species identification and density via transecting
- Authored a research paper including statistical analysis and graphical displays using RStudio

MARINE BIOLOGY & TERRESTRIAL ECOLOGY UCEAP

Mangrove Ecosystems Research Project

Brisbane, Australia

August 2025 - November 2025

- Collected underwater video data Baited Remote Underwater Video systems (BRUVs) to assess species density within different mangrove root structures.
- Identified and quantified species presence and total organism abundance within video frames
- Authored a research paper incorporating an extensive literature review and quantitative analysis examining the relationship between mangrove root structures and fish abundance and diversity

UCSB CHEADLE CENTER

Aquatic Invertebrate Lab Intern

Santa Barbara, CA

January 2025 - June 2025

- Sorted, organized and collected aquatic invertebrate samples from the Devereux Slough
- Identified species using a microscope and documented biological data for ongoing data bank
- Supported student-led research aimed at understanding and preserving natural ecosystems.

CRITICAL THINKING IN THE ENVIRONMENT

Research Project

Santa Barbara, CA

January 2024 - March 2024

- Analyzed the social, economic, and environmental impact of the Olympic Surf Watch Tower in Tahiti
- Synthesized data from peer-reviewed marine science literature on coral reef ecology
- Produced an analytical longform article using a collection of online data analysis

BIOMA: SEA TURTLE CONSERVATION PROGRAM

Ostional, Costa Rica

Research Intern

August 2024

- Collected biological data supporting Olive Ridley population management and conservation
- Recorded physical measurements and entered data into software platforms for analysis
- Communicated with locals on effective conservation efforts and analyzed local policy on Olive Ridley conservation

Leadership and Activities

UCSB Writing Department

Santa Barbara, CA

Writing for Environmental Action Intern

(April 2026 - Present)

- Assist lead professors in developing materials for a new Professional Writing minor track
- Spearhead outreach initiatives and develop list of potential related organizations pertaining to the minor
- Lead in person focus groups and online surveys to undergraduates to gather informative feedback and opinions
- Summarize survey results into prose for a proposal document to be sent to the Writing Department

TURTLE UP

Santa Barbara, CA

Outreach Officer

January 2026 – Present

- Attend weekly meetings to plan club initiatives and events
- Collaborate on advertising strategies and future programming
- Lead outreach efforts to promote the club and coordinate events with other student organizations

SPROUT UP

Santa Barbara, CA

Instructor

January 2026 – Present

- Teach First and Second Grade students at local Santa Barbara elementary schools about environmental sciences
- Practice science communication skills in a variety of settings
- Attend weekly lessons, facilitate lessons, and generate meaningful engagement between students

Kindergarten Materials Coordinator

March 2026 - Present

- Review kindergarten lessons and purchase required materials
- Set up materials for each weekly lesson in an organized fashion

GAMMA RHO CHAPTER - KAPPA ALPHA THETA

Santa Barbara, CA

Ritualist

January 2026 – Present

- Uphold and oversee chapter traditions and ritual practices, adhering to schedules
- Promote active member engagement and participation
- Plan and coordinate events for new members to support their transition into the chapter

GAMMA RHO CHAPTER - KAPPA ALPHA THETA

Santa Barbara, CA

Sustainability Chair

August 2024 - June 2025

- Collaborated with Gauchos Go Green to maintain the Green Certification status of the chapter house
- Implemented composting and recycling practices, reducing household waste
- Educated peers on sustainable living, and encouraged participation in local beach-clean ups

Work Experience

HOLONOMY EDUCATION

Manhattan Beach, CA

Operational Assistant

January 2022 - Present

- Manage financial records using QuickBooks to ensure accurate documentation and reporting.
- Design and prepare visual materials and organizational tools to support professional training sessions
- Compile, organize and summarize training evaluations to support program development and improvement

HEAL THE BAY

Manhattan Beach, CA

Photoshoot Producer

June 2025 - August 2025

- Coordinated and executed a merchandise photoshoot, including scouting locations, recruiting models, and managing shoot logistics.
- Directed styling and presentation of merchandise to align with brand aesthetics and goals.

- Collaborated with the photographer to stage and capture high-quality images for promotional use.
- Scheduled and managed a diverse team to meet tight deadlines and ensure a smooth shoot.
- Assisted in rebranding efforts by curating and supplying high-resolution imagery to elevate the visual quality of the organization's website.

REI CO-OP

Store Sales Specialist

Santa Barbara, CA
April 2025 - June 2025

- Assisted customers with product selection and service, achieving measurable increases in customer satisfaction.
- Monitored and restocked frontline inventory to maintain product availability and reduce stockouts.
- Reorganized back stock for faster retrieval and improved team efficiency during peak shifts.
- Promoted membership benefits to customers, driving measurable growth in sign-ups.
- Processed transactions, returns, and handled phone inquiries while maintaining accurate tender and store announcements.

FREEDOM SURF

Surf Instructor

Manhattan Beach, CA
June-September 2023 & 2024

- Led groups of children in outdoor activities, ensuring safety and fostering a positive, supportive environment
- Taught surfing techniques, providing hands-on guidance while adapting to individual learning styles
- Developed strong communication, leadership, and problem-solving skills by working closely with participants and colleagues in a fast-paced setting, ensuring smooth operations and meeting group goals.

Volunteering

SANTA BARBARA CHANNELKEEPER

MPA Watch Volunteer

Santa Barbara, CA
January 2026 – Present

- Conduct field surveys documenting recreational and boating activity within Marine Protected Areas along Isla Vista coastline
- Collect, record and organize observational field data to support marine protection and compliance with the MPA

JIMMY MILLER FOUNDATION

Surf Instructor Volunteer

Manhattan Beach, CA
June 2024 - Present

- Teach neurodiverse, veteran, and underprivileged groups how to surf, fostering ocean confidence and accessibility
- Promote inclusivity and environmental respect through ocean-based activities
- Practice team collaboration with co-instructors and students, ensuring a safe and engaging experience

UCSB CHEMISTRY OUTREACH PROGRAM

Volunteer Instructor + Lead

Santa Barbara, CA
September 2023 - Present

- Teach fifth graders from local elementary schools chemistry through scientific demonstrations
- Demonstrate scientific phenomena and explain real-world applications, which enhances communication skills crucial for effectively advocating for sustainable ocean practices
- Encourage and inspire younger generations to explore STEM, promoting education, teamwork, and personal growth.
- Advocate for sustainability by connecting scientific concepts like ocean acidification to environmental responsibility

Skills & Interests

Technical: Microsoft Word, Excel, Google Workspace, RStudio (statistical analysis and data visualization)

Language: Proficient in Spanish (Conversational)

Laboratory: Biological surveys, transecting, environmental monitoring, species identification, ecological data recording

Interests: Outdoor activities, conservation, sustainability, ecological research